

**Econ 10010/20010: Principles of Microeconomics
Fall 2026
University of Notre Dame**

Course Details

Instructor: Xinyi Li
Email: xli35@nd.edu
Office Location: Jenkins and Nanovic Hall (JNH) 3018
Class Times: Tuesday/Thursday from 12:30 pm - 1:45 pm
Class Location: Main Building 404
Class Site: canvas.nd.edu
Office Hours: Monday 5:30-7:00pm (JNH 3060F); Thursday 4:00-5:00pm (JNH 3002)
Or by appointment (JNH 3018)

Course Overview

Every day, people face tradeoffs about how to spend their time, money, and effort. Firms face similar decisions about what to produce, how much to produce, and how to compete in the marketplace. This undergraduate course serves as an introduction to microeconomics, the study of how individuals, businesses, and societies make choices when resources are scarce—in other words, “who gets what, how, and why.”

Throughout the course, we will explore questions such as: What is a market? How are prices determined? What makes markets work—and sometimes fail? How do consumers and firms make decisions? We will learn how economists approach these questions using simple but powerful analytical tools. By developing economic intuition and working with simple models, we will see how economics can shed light on complicated real-world problems.

By the end of the course, you will have a basic foundation in “how to think like an economist” when analyzing everyday decisions and policy questions.

Course Materials

Textbook

There is no required textbook for this class. If you come to class and take notes, you should have all the necessary information. If you would like a textbook to refer to when you have questions or to have access to additional practice problems, here is the reference I suggest:

- Microeconomics; Hubbard and O’Brien; Pearson Publishing, any edition.

Poll Everywhere

During lectures, you will participate in Poll Everywhere questions using the Poll Everywhere software. Prior to our first in-class poll, you must register your device with Poll Everywhere. Registration details for Poll Everywhere can be found on Canvas. Participation requires that you have access to an internet-capable device (cell phone or tablet, no laptop).

Calculator

A non-graphing calculator

Communication

I will communicate class announcements through announcements on Canvas. You can set up notifications from Canvas to be sent to you via email. Outside of class, we will mostly communicate through email. For all email communications, please use your @nd.edu address. I will do my best to respond to emails within 24 hours, except for weekends, when you can expect a response from me by no later than following business day.

Requirements and Grading Rubric

- A. Attendance and Participation (5%)** Attendance is required. The only exceptions are absences which are excused due to official University-sanctioned activities, illness, or unforeseen emergencies. In general, you should communicate with me prior to any excused absence, and follow up by providing documentation to verify the reason for the absence. I will work with you, either by providing a recording of the lecture and/or through a personal appointment, to ensure that you are caught up on any material missed due to an excused absence.

Everyone is expected to participate in class. A large portion of lecture time will be devoted to discussion and in-class exercises, so the more that you engage with the material during class, the more that you (and your classmates) will get out of this course.

Along with asking and answering questions during lectures, we will use Poll Everywhere to facilitate engagement. During lecture, I will often present multiple-choice questions and you will use the Poll Everywhere to respond. Prior to our first class, you will receive information on how to activate your Poll Everywhere account and set up the Poll Everywhere app for your phone or tablet.

Your Attendance and Participation grade will be based on the percentage of Poll Everywhere questions that you *answer* – not the percentage that you answer correctly. To allow for technical problems and other issues, there will be a curve on your Poll Everywhere score (not to exceed a total score of 100%).

- B. Problem Sets (20%)** The problem sets are designed to help you grasp and apply the concepts discussed in class. You are permitted (and encouraged) to work in groups on the problem sets, but each person must submit their own assignment. All problem sets will be due on Gradescope at 11.59pm on the due date. Assignments received after the deadline will receive a maximum score of 50%. There will be 8 problem sets assigned throughout the course. Each problem set is weighted equally. I will drop your lowest problem set score.
- C. Presentations (5%)** Each student will be required to participate in one 3-person presentation at the end of the semester. Each group of students will choose an article and then present the article. Each presentation should be about eight minutes (7 min presentation + 3 min Q&A), and students may not be able to cover all the material in the article. At a minimum, each presentation should address the following (1) What are the main economic concepts discussed in the article? (2) How can these concepts be explained using the economic tools and principles we have learned in class? Beyond these requirements, you are free to decide which aspects of the article to emphasize, what material to omit, and what additional insights, applications, or extensions you would like

to share with the class. Creativity and thoughtful connections to course material are encouraged.

- D. Midterm (40%)** There would be two in-term exams. Midterms will be held during normal class time. For each midterm, you are allowed to bring in *one side* of an 8.5 x 11-inch sheet of paper with anything *written* that might help you on the exam. There are no makeup midterms for unexcused absences. Any excused absences must have university approval. If you miss one or more midterms, the weight (20% each) will be transferred to the final exam. For example, if you miss one midterm, your final exam will be worth 50% of your total grade (30% + 20%). In the event that i) your score on the final is above your lowest midterm score, and ii) you took both midterm exams, the weight on your lowest midterm score will be reduced by 15% and the weight on the final increased by 15%, such that your lowest midterm will only be worth 5% and your final would be worth 45%. If you miss a midterm for an unexcused reason, you will lose the opportunity to reduce the percentage of your lowest midterm.
- E. Final Exam (30%)** The final exam will take place on Dec 11, 2026 10:30-12:30 in a room to be announced later. Per ND rules, you must have a valid excuse from the Dean to take the final exam at a time other than the scheduled time. Other university exam policies can be found online (<https://al.nd.edu/advising/academic-policies/final-exams/>). If you miss the final exam and do not have an excuse from the Dean, you will receive a score of 0% on your final. For the final, you may use a *two-sided* 8.5 x 11-inch sheet of paper containing your own handwritten notes.

Letter grades will be assigned as follows:

A	93-100
A-	90-92.99
B+	87-89.99
B	83-86.99
B-	80-82.99
C+	77-79.99
C	73-76.99
C-	70-72.99
D	60-69.99
F	0-59.99

I will be using the gradebook on the course website through Canvas. This will allow you to keep close track of your performance in the course.

Phone/Laptop Policy

This course is designed so that you do not need a laptop during lecture. Research shows that in-class laptop use has a negative impact on learning outcomes and overall course performance (<https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S0272775716303454>). Therefore, laptops are not permitted during class. Additionally, phone/tablet use is not permitted in class, except as a mean to access “Poll Everywhere”. If you are observed using a phone or laptop during class, your participation score will be reduced.

If you think that taking notes on a tablet would be especially beneficial for you, please talk to me during the first week of class and we can discuss an exception.

Academic Honesty

You are expected not to engage in academic dishonesty. One of the goals of this course is to build the basic foundations of microeconomic analysis and prepare you to do well in advanced economics courses, so it is essential that you develop a solid understanding of the material. To that end, while collaboration on problem sets is encouraged in this course, copying is not. Students are expected to understand and abide by the Academic Code of Honor Pledge: “As a member of the Notre Dame community, I will not participate in or tolerate academic dishonesty.”

Use of AI

Before beginning your studies at Notre Dame, you signed the Honor Code pledge, affirming that you would not tolerate or participate in academic dishonesty, and this includes the appropriate use of generative AI tools. Please see the overall university statement on generative AI. For the purposes of this class (and many others) you should think about generative AI as a complement to your learning and not a substitute. Using AI as a replacement to thinking deeply about something is counterproductive in the long run (remember why you’re here). As a quick rule of thumb, if you felt like you’re taking a shortcut that you shouldn’t, you’re almost surely taking a shortcut that you shouldn’t.

Honor Code – Exams

The only resources you are allowed to use during an exam are:

- A pencil
- A calculator
- For each midterm, you are allowed to bring in one side of an 8.5 x 11" sheet of paper with anything on it legible to your naked eye. For the final you are allowed to have both sides of one 8.5 × 11-inch sheet.

Support for Mental Health

The University Counseling Center (UCC) provides cost-free and confidential mental health services to help you manage personal challenges that threaten your emotional or academic well-being. Remember, getting help is a smart and courageous thing to do. For more resources, please see ucc.nd.edu. During our course period, you can also speak with me at any time if you would like to.

Disability Services

It is the policy and practice of the University of Notre Dame to provide reasonable accommodations for students with properly documented disabilities. Students who have questions about the Office of Disability Services or who have, or think they may have, a disability are invited to contact the Office of Disability Services for a confidential discussion in the Sara Bea Center for Students with Disabilities or by phone at (574) 631-7833. Because the University's Academic Accommodations Processes generally require students to request accommodations well in advance of the dates when they are needed, students who believe they may need an accommodation for this course are encouraged to contact the Office of Disability Services at their earliest opportunity. Additional information about Disability Services and the process for requesting accommodations may be found at supportandcare.nd.edu.

Inclusive Classroom

The University of Notre Dame is committed to social justice. I share that commitment and strive to maintain a positive learning environment based on open communication, mutual respect, and non-discrimination. In this class, we will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, age, economic class, disability, veteran status, religion, sexual orientation, gender identity, color, or national origin. Any suggestions as to how to further such a positive and open environment will be appreciated and given serious consideration.

Title IX:

Lauren's Promise: I will listen and believe you if someone is threatening or harassing you. Lauren McCluskey, a 21-year-old student at the University of Utah and the daughter of economist Jill McCluskey was murdered on Oct. 22, 2018 by a man she briefly dated. I am committed to doing what I can to make sure this does not happen again.

If you are in immediate danger, call 911. If you are experiencing sexual assault, domestic violence, stalking, or harassment you can report it to me. You should be aware that I am a mandatory reporter, which means that I am required to report these instances to the university's Title IX Coordinator or Deputy Title IX Coordinator to investigate. You can also learn about your options (on-campus and off-campus, confidential and not) at <https://equity.nd.edu/>.

The University of Notre Dame provides services for those who have been affected by sexual assault, sexual misconduct, dating or domestic violence, stalking and any conduct that creates a hostile environment. For help and further information including contact information for on and off-campus resources, please consult <https://equity.nd.edu/resources/>.

Tentative Course Outline (Subject to Change)

Below you will find a course outline with class dates and topics. The course outline may shift depending on the speed at which we move through material. I will make in class announcements and send messages via email should I need to adjust any due dates.

Week	Date		Topic
1	Tuesday	8/25	Intro
	Thursday	8/27	Trade and Markets
2	Tuesday	9/1	Trade and Markets
	Thursday	9/3	Consumer Choice
3	Tuesday	9/8	Demand
	Thursday	9/10	Demand/ Supply
4	Tuesday	9/15	Supply
	Thursday	9/17	Equilibrium
5	Tuesday	9/22	Equilibrium
	Thursday	9/24	Elasticity
6	Tuesday	9/29	Elasticity
	Thursday	10/1	Price controls
7	Tuesday	10/6	EXAM 1
	Thursday	10/8	Taxation
8	Tuesday	10/13	Subsidies
	Thursday	10/15	Externalities
9	Tuesday	10/20	NO CLASS - FALL BREAK
	Thursday	10/22	NO CLASS - FALL BREAK
10	Tuesday	10/27	Externalities
	Thursday	10/29	Public Goods
11	Tuesday	11/3	EXAM 2
	Thursday	11/5	Producer Theory
12	Tuesday	11/10	Producer Theory
	Thursday	11/12	Producer Theory
13	Tuesday	11/17	Perfect Competition
	Thursday	11/19	Monopoly and Market Power
14	Tuesday	11/24	Monopolistic Competition
	Thursday	11/26	NO CLASS - THANKSGIVING
15	Tuesday	12/1	Oligopoly and Game Theory
	Thursday	12/3	Class Presentation
16	Tuesday	12/8	Class Presentation and Wrap Up
	Friday	12/11	FINAL EXAM 10:30-12:30(location TBD)

Problem Sets Due Date (Subject to Change)

Problem Sets	Due Date
Problem Set #1	Monday 9/7
Problem Set #2	Monday 9/21
Problem Set #3	Monday 9/28
Problem Set #4	Monday 10/19
Problem Set #5	Sunday 11/1
Problem Set #6	Monday 11/16
Problem Set #7	Monday 11/23
Problem Set #8	Monday 12/7

All problem sets are due at 11:59pm on the scheduled date. This is a tentative schedule; the due dates are subject to change depends on our progress.